Riverside Community Hospital (Fictional)

Appointment and Cancellation Policy - Version 3.2

FICTIONAL DOCUMENT FOR SOFTWARE DEMONSTRATION ONLY. Riverside Community Hospital does not exist. This is not medical advice.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains how outpatient appointments are scheduled, confirmed, changed and cancelled at Riverside Community Hospital. It applies to all outpatient clinics, the imaging department and the outpatient laboratory. It does not apply to emergency care.

2. Scheduling appointments

Appointments can be booked by telephone Monday to Friday between 7:30 and 18:00, through the patient portal at any time, or in person at the main reception desk. New patients must provide a photo ID and insurance details at least 24 hours before their first visit.

3. Appointment reminders

Reminders are sent by SMS or email 48 hours before every appointment. Patients are asked to reply CONFIRM to keep the appointment. Appointments that are not confirmed are still held, but the scheduling team may call the patient once on the day before the visit.

4. Cancelling and rescheduling

Outpatient clinic appointments must be cancelled or rescheduled at least 24 hours in advance. A late cancellation fee of USD 25 applies to outpatient clinic visits cancelled with less than 24 hours' notice. Imaging appointments (MRI, CT and ultrasound) require at least 48 hours' notice, and a late cancellation fee of USD 50 applies.

5. Late arrival

A grace period of 15 minutes is allowed. After 15 minutes the appointment may be rescheduled to the next available slot, depending on clinic capacity. Patients who arrive late for imaging may need to rebook because of preparation requirements.

6. Missed appointments (no-shows)

A no-show is recorded when a patient neither attends nor cancels. After three no-shows within 12 months, the patient is placed under scheduling review: future appointments must be confirmed by telephone at least 24 hours before the visit, otherwise they may be released to other patients.

7. Fee waivers and appeals

Late cancellation and no-show fees are waived for documented emergencies, hospital-initiated closures and severe weather alerts issued by local authorities. Appeals must be submitted in writing to Patient Accounts within 14 days of the fee notice. Patient Accounts replies within 10 business days.

8. Interpreter and accessibility services

Interpreter services, including sign language, are provided at no cost. Requests should be made at least 3 business days before the appointment. Wheelchair-accessible entrances are located at the north and east sides of the main building.

9. Contacts (fictional)

Scheduling Office: 555-0100 (fictional number). Patient Accounts: 555-0142 (fictional number). Document owner: Office of Outpatient Services. Effective date: 1 January 2025.